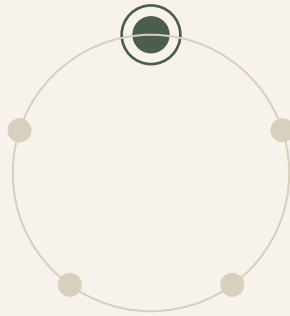


ONE OF THE 5 HIDDEN TRIGGERS



The Stillness Trigger, 10-Day Reset

*Give your vessels back the movement signal that keeps
them flexible and responsive, even on the calm days.*

by Joel Polley, RN

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The Stillness Trigger Reset

First, thank you. You showed up, and showing up is the part most people never do. If your quiz landed you here, it means stillness is the loudest of your five triggers right now, and that is good news, because it means we already know where to start.

Here is the chain your body is running, in plain English. Movement is a signal, not just a way to burn calories. Every time you move, your muscles squeeze blood through your vessels, and that flow tells the lining of your arteries to stay flexible and to release nitric oxide, the molecule that lets them relax and open. When you sit unbroken for long stretches, a desk, a car, the couch, that signal goes quiet. Circulation slows, nitric oxide production falls, and your vessels slowly lose some of their responsiveness.

The result is a baseline reading that creeps upward even on days that felt completely calm. It can be confusing, because you did not do anything stressful, you did not eat badly, and still the number is up. This is why. Your vessels are not asking for a hard workout. They are asking for the movement signal they were built to expect all day long, and they have been going too many hours without it.

Hear this clearly, because it changes everything about how you approach these ten days. This is not about gym intensity or crushing a workout. Plenty of people exercise once and then sit unbroken for ten or twelve hours around it, and the vessels feel the sitting far more than the workout. It is about how long your vessels go between movement signals. And if bad knees, a bad hip, a walker, or your balance limit you, chair-based movement counts. We are after the signal, not the height you rise to.

We follow one simple shape: find it, eliminate it, add what heals, supplement, then watch your body respond. Day 1 you name it and take your baseline. Days 2 and 3 you cut what feeds the stillness. Days 4 and 5 you add the keystone practice and the foods. Days 6 and 7 you bring in the herbs and start tracking. Days 8 and 9 you read the signals and watch the number move. Day 10 you lock in your keystone habit and point your steps toward the trigger that most often travels beside this one.

Nothing gets ripped away. Each day stacks on the one before it. Build over days, not hours. Consistency beats intensity, and with this trigger that is the whole secret.

A word before we start, and I mean this. This is education that walks alongside your doctor, never instead of your doctor. Nothing here replaces medical care, and you never stop or change a prescription on your own. Med changes are your doctor's call, made with your numbers in front of both of you. Our job is to give your body what it needs and let the data lead the conversation.

1 Day 1

FIND

Phase: FIND. Today's action: Name the stillness, take your baseline blood pressure, and honestly count your sitting hours.

You cannot change what you have not named. So today we name the stillness, and we draw a starting line you can measure everything else against.

Here is the truth most people never get told. It is not the workout you skipped that is quietly raising your numbers. It is the hours your vessels spend with no movement signal at all. Movement is a signal, not just calorie burning. When you sit unbroken for long stretches, at a desk, in a car seat, on the couch after supper, your blood vessels stop getting the message to stay flexible and responsive. Circulation slows, your body makes less nitric oxide, the signal that tells your arteries to relax and open, and your baseline pressure can creep upward even on days that felt completely calm. This is the Stillness Trigger, and naming it accurately is the first piece of power you get back.

This is not about being lazy or out of shape. Plenty of people who exercise still sit unbroken for ten or twelve hours around that one workout, and the vessels feel the sitting far more than they feel the workout. And if your knees, hips, or balance limit you, hear me clearly: chair-based movement counts. We are after the signal, not the intensity.

Do this today:

1. Take your blood pressure. Sit quietly for five minutes first, feet flat, back supported, same arm you will use every day. Take two or three readings a minute apart, discard the first, and average the rest. Write the number down. This is your baseline. No judgment, just data.
2. Honestly count your sitting hours. Walk through a normal day in your mind, hour by hour, and tally how many of your waking hours you spend seated without getting up. Most people are surprised. Write the honest number down.
3. Find your longest unbroken sitting block. Is it the morning desk stretch, the commute, the evening on the couch? Circle the single longest stretch you sit without standing. That is your first target.

You are not broken. You are not lazy. You are not just getting older. Your vessels have simply gone too long without the one thing they were built to expect, regular movement, and that is one of the most fixable things there is. Tomorrow we start giving it back. Tonight, rest well. We are just getting started.

2 Day 2

ELIMINATE

Phase: ELIMINATE. Today's action: Break up your longest unbroken sitting blocks, and set down the exercise-later bargain.

Yesterday you named the stillness and found your longest sitting block. Today you remove the single biggest thing feeding the trigger. We do not add anything yet. One clear change.

The number one driver of the Stillness Trigger is the unbroken sitting block, any stretch of two hours or more where your body never stands up. It is not just the total sitting that hurts your vessels, it is the length of each unbroken stretch. Two hours seated without a break tells your arteries the movement signal has stopped, circulation pools, and nitric oxide production falls off. The vessels stiffen a little more with each silent hour.

There is a bargain almost everyone makes, and I want to name it so you can set it down: I will exercise later, so it is fine to sit all day now. A single workout is wonderful, but it does not buy back ten unbroken hours in a chair. Your vessels do not average the day. They respond to what is happening right now, this hour. A person who moves a little every hour is doing more for their pressure than a person who crushes one workout and then sits like a stone until bedtime.

Do this today:

1. Break your longest block in half. Whatever stretch you circled yesterday, interrupt it today with at least one stand-up. Set a phone timer, or stand every time an episode ends or a call comes in.
2. Refuse to sit longer than about two hours unbroken, anywhere. Desk, car (pull over safely on long drives), couch. When you hit the two-hour mark, stand up, even for thirty seconds.
3. Drop the exercise-later bargain out loud. Tell yourself plainly: the workout is a bonus, the hourly movement is the medicine. Today you stop trading one for the other.

Notice we are not asking you to exercise more. We are asking you to sit unbroken less. That is a different thing, and it is far easier. If standing is hard on you, breaking the block can be as simple as marching your feet or doing seated leg lifts in your chair. The signal is what matters, not the height you rise to. One removal today. Well done.

3 Day 3

ELIMINATE

Phase: ELIMINATE. Today's action: Cut the convenience defaults that erase your movement, and set down caffeine, swapping to hibiscus tea.

Yesterday you broke up your longest sitting block. Today we strip the small, silent defaults that quietly remove movement from your day, and we cut one stimulant that works against this whole trigger. Then your removal phase is done.

Modern life is engineered to keep you still. The elevator instead of the stairs. The closest parking spot. The drive-thru where you eat sitting in the car instead of walking in. Groceries and meals delivered to the door. Each one is sold as convenience, and each one quietly deletes a small movement signal your vessels were counting on. None of them is a moral failing. They are simply defaults, and today you change the defaults.

There is one more thing to set down: caffeine. Coffee, energy drinks, strong tea, soda. Caffeine constricts your blood vessels and can push your pressure up within half an hour of the cup, which is the exact opposite of what we are trying to do for vessels that already need help relaxing. Do not just subtract it, though. Swap it. Reach for hibiscus tea instead. Hibiscus actively supports this trigger, gently encouraging fluid balance and circulation while you sip, so you are trading up, not white-knuckling a gap.

Do this today:

1. Take the stairs when it is a flight or two and your body allows. If stairs are not safe for you, park a little farther out instead, or add one extra lap indoors.
2. Park farther away on purpose. Choose the far spot, not the close one. Those few hundred steps, several times a day, are exactly the signal your vessels are missing.
3. Stop eating in the car. Park, walk in, sit down, or better, take a short walk after. Drive-thru eating pairs stillness with a hurried meal, the worst of both.
4. Cut the caffeine and swap to hibiscus tea. If you have leaned on caffeine hard, expect a day or two of a dull headache as your body recalibrates. That is the stimulant leaving, not a sign you need it. Drink more water and walk it off.

That is the whole removal phase. You have stopped feeding the stillness and stopped constricting the vessels you are trying to open. From here on we stop subtracting and start adding the things that actively bring your vessels back to life. The hardest part, the letting go, is behind you.

4 Day 4

ADD

Phase: ADD. Today's action: Add the keystone practice: a short movement break every 60 to 90 minutes.

The removal phase is complete. Now we add. Today you get the single most important practice for this trigger, and it is one you carry in your own body, for free, for the rest of your life.

It is the movement break, and it is not exercise in the way you are picturing. Here is the mechanism. Every time you stand up and move, even for two minutes, your leg muscles contract and squeeze blood back through your vessels. That flow is the signal. It tells the lining of your arteries to release nitric oxide, the molecule that lets them relax and open. Sit unbroken and the signal goes quiet. Move briefly every hour or so and you keep sending it all day long. You are not trying to burn calories. You are keeping a conversation going between your muscles and your vessels.

The rhythm that works is a short movement break every 60 to 90 minutes. Not a workout. Two minutes. The point is frequency, not intensity. Ten two-minute breaks scattered through the day do more for vessel flexibility than one long session wrapped around ten still hours.

Do this today:

1. Every 60 to 90 minutes, stand up and move for at least two minutes. Set a gentle timer if you need to. Walk to the window, down the hall, around the room.
2. Use the idle moments you already have. During TV commercials or a phone call, do a set of calf raises (rise onto your toes and back down) or sit-to-stands (stand up from the chair and sit back down slowly, several times). They need no equipment, and they pump the vessels beautifully.
3. If standing or walking is limited for you, do it seated. Ankle pumps, seated marching, lifting one leg then the other. Chair-based movement sends the same signal. Do not skip the break just because you cannot stand easily.

Anchor this movement break as the practice you do every single day. Everything else we add stacks on top of it.

One more thing to weave in when you can: get outside for a short unhurried walk in the daylight. The walking sends the signal and the sunlight supports your whole rhythm. If you pray, make it a prayer walk, moving your body while you hand over the day. "They shall walk and not faint" (Isaiah 40:31). Movement and trust, in the same steps.

5 Day 5

ADD

Phase: ADD. Today's action: Add the nitric-oxide plants, the potassium foods, the plant omega-3s, and plenty of water.

You have the practice. Today you add the food, because what you put on your plate either helps your vessels relax or works against them. We go plant-forward and whole-food, the way your body was designed to be fed.

The goal today is to feed the vessels the raw materials for nitric oxide, the same signal your movement breaks are switching back on. Food and movement push the same lever from two directions. We also want to lighten the load your vessels carry, with potassium to balance fluid and with plenty of water, because dehydration quietly thickens the blood and makes every vessel work harder.

Do this today:

1. Lean on nitric-oxide plants. Beets and beet juice, leafy greens, and raw garlic. For the garlic, crush two cloves, let them rest ten minutes so the active compound forms, then take them with your largest meal. These give your arteries back the raw material to relax and open. One caution: if you take a blood thinner or have a surgery coming up, clear daily raw garlic with your doctor first, because garlic can add to blood-thinning effects.
2. Add potassium-rich plants most days. Sweet potato, beans, spinach, banana, and other fresh produce. Potassium helps your body balance fluid, which eases the volume pushing against your vessel walls.
3. Get your omega-3s from plants. Walnuts, ground flaxseed, and chia seeds. These support flexible, healthy vessels, and the plant sources give you what you need without the hidden load that comes with animal foods.
4. Drink water, and plenty of it. Pair a tall glass with each movement break so the two habits ride together. Dehydration thickens the blood and raises the load on your vessels, and most people walking around tired are simply running dry.

Build your meals from whole, plant-based ingredients: vegetables, fruit, beans, lentils, whole grains, nuts, and seeds. Cook from real food rather than packaged food. Your plate becomes part of the medicine, and it works alongside the movement, not instead of it. Keep yesterday's movement breaks going. Today the kitchen joins the team.

6 Day 6

SUPPLEMENT

Phase: SUPPLEMENT. Today's action: Introduce hawthorn, the circulation keystone, then bring in daily hibiscus tea.

The stillness is broken up, the practice is in, the foods are on the plate. Now we add targeted botanical support. These are the herbs I trust for vessels that have gone stiff from too little movement, and every one is in the Formulary at the end of this guide with its full detail. Read that section before you start.

The rule that matters most: add ONE herb at a time, and check your blood pressure daily so you can see what each one does for you. This is exactly how a careful clinician layers in support, watching the response before adding the next lever.

Start with hawthorn. This is the circulation keystone, the traditional heart and vessel herb, used for generations to support healthy circulation and the tone of the blood vessels. It is a slow, steady worker. You will not feel it in an hour. Its effect builds quietly over weeks as it supports the vessels you are working to keep flexible. Think of it as the botanical partner to your movement breaks: the breaks send the signal, the hawthorn supports the vessel that receives it.

After hawthorn has been in for a few days and your readings are steady, bring in daily hibiscus tea, the same swap you started on Day 3, now as a deliberate daily support. Hibiscus is traditionally used to support fluid balance and circulation, and many people find it a calm, pleasant ritual to drink a cup or two through the day in place of the caffeine they set down.

Do this today:

1. Start hawthorn today, following the product labeling for the amount, taken with food. Give it time. This one rewards patience, not impatience.
2. Check your blood pressure daily as you begin. One herb, watched closely, before anything else joins it.
3. Keep hibiscus tea going as your daily caffeine replacement, one or two cups through the day.

The safety conversation, in plain terms. If you take blood pressure medication, these herbs can lower your pressure further. That is the goal, but it must happen with monitoring. Check your BP daily. If readings run consistently low, below about 110/70, or you feel dizzy or lightheaded, contact your doctor about your medication. Hawthorn deserves special care: if you take digoxin, or any heart or blood pressure medication, talk with your doctor before you start, because hawthorn works on the same systems. Do not adjust any medication on your own. Tell your doctor everything you are adding. Two supports in is plenty for today.

7 Day 7

SUPPLEMENT + MONITOR

Phase: SUPPLEMENT + MONITOR. Today's action: Complete your stack with magnesium glycinate and a tiny bit of cayenne, then begin tracking your numbers.

Your full stack goes into place today, and at the same time we start watching what your body is telling you. From here, you are not guessing. You are reading data.

Complete the stack, one addition at a time, only as your readings stay steady. First, magnesium glycinate, 300 to 400 mg with dinner or before bed. Magnesium relaxes the smooth muscle in your vessel walls so your arteries can open more easily, and it corrects one of the most common deficiencies in people with high blood pressure. Glycinate is the gold-standard form for absorption and comfort. Avoid magnesium oxide, which your body barely absorbs.

Then, if you tolerate it, cayenne, the traditional circulation spark. Start with a tiny pinch, in food or stirred into warm water. Cayenne has been used for generations to support circulation and warmth, and a little goes a long way. Start tiny and build only if it sits well with you. This is the one to be most gentle and patient with.

Do this today:

1. Track your morning blood pressure. Same conditions every time: seated five minutes, same arm, two or three readings averaged. The single daily number is your anchor.
2. Track your afternoon stiffness on a 1 to 10 scale. How stiff or heavy do your legs and body feel after the day's sitting? This is the trigger's signature signal, and it often eases before the number does.
3. Track your evening ankles and rings. Do your socks leave deeper marks, do your rings feel tighter by night? Note it. Easing puffiness is a sign your circulation and fluid balance are improving.

The safety rules still govern everything. One new thing at a time, BP checked daily, everything reported to your doctor. Cayenne can add to blood thinners, so if you take one, clear it with your doctor first, and go easy if your stomach is sensitive. Magnesium is cleared by your kidneys, so if you have reduced kidney function talk with your doctor before supplementing, and if you take a calcium-channel blocker, know that magnesium works on a similar pathway and needs daily monitoring.

Write your numbers down daily, on paper or your phone. What you are building is a trend line, and the trend is where the truth lives. Tomorrow we read what it is starting to say.

8 Day 8

MONITOR

Phase: MONITOR. Today's action: Read your signals, and compare how you feel on the days you move against the days you sit.

Today you do not add anything. You read. You have a few days of data now, and learning to interpret it is a skill that will serve you for the rest of your life.

Here is the comparison that teaches you the most with this trigger: your energy and your readings on the days you moved often, against the days you sat unbroken. This is the clearest mirror of the Stillness Trigger at work. Most people find that on the days they took their movement breaks and got their walk, they felt lighter, their legs felt less stiff by evening, and their numbers trended kinder. On the days they slipped back into long unbroken sitting, the heaviness and the higher readings came back. That contrast is not a coincidence. It is the signal, showing up in how you feel.

Here is the order things tend to move, so you know what to look for. Energy and stiffness usually shift first. Within the first several days of hourly movement, many people notice their legs feel less heavy, the afternoon slump eases, and they get up from a chair more easily. The puffiness in the ankles and rings softens next. Blood pressure follows, and it moves on the trend, not day to day. One high reading is noise. The average over a week is signal.

Do this today:

1. Look back across your readings since Day 7. Ask three questions. Is my afternoon stiffness easing? Is the evening puffiness softening? Is my BP trend, the average, starting to ease?
2. Compare a moving day against a sitting day. Find one of each in your notes and read the difference in how you felt and what the cuff said.
3. Name what has moved first for you. Write it in one sentence: "My ____ is the first thing that changed."

If nothing has moved yet, do not lose heart. Hawthorn works quietly and builds over weeks, and vessels that have been still for years do not wake up in a day. You are days in. Stay consistent.

Reading your own signals with calm curiosity, rather than watching the cuff with fear, is part of the healing. The body keeps its appointments.

9 Day 9

WATCH IT HEAL

Phase: WATCH IT HEAL. Today's action: Connect what you removed and added to what your body is now doing.

Today you connect what you removed and added to what your body is doing, so you understand the why, not just the result. When you understand the mechanism, you own it, and no one can take that knowledge back.

Look at what has shifted since Day 1. Whatever has moved, lighter legs, less evening puffiness, more energy on your moving days, an easing trend on the cuff, here is the chain of why behind it. You broke up the long unbroken sitting, so your vessels stopped going hour after hour with no signal. You added a movement break every 60 to 90 minutes and a daily walk, so you sent that signal again and again, and your arteries started making the nitric oxide that lets them relax. You fed your body nitric-oxide plants, potassium, plant omega-3s, and plenty of water, so you gave the vessels the raw materials and lightened the load they carry. You added hawthorn, hibiscus, magnesium, and a little cayenne, so you supported circulation and helped the vessel walls open.

Every one of those moves the same direction: more movement signal, more nitric oxide, more flexible vessels, better circulation, and a lighter load pushing against your walls. You did not mask a number. You gave your vessels back the one thing they were missing. That is the whole difference between managing a reading and helping your body work the way it was built to.

Do this today:

1. Write down your single biggest win since Day 1, in one sentence. Make it concrete: "My legs stopped feeling like concrete by 4 PM," or "My morning average dropped from ____ to ____."
2. Notice that your body did this. You did not force it. You removed what was harming it and gave it what it needed, and it knew how to respond.

Sit with that for a moment. This is what it feels like to work with your body instead of fighting it. Your vessels were waiting for the signal the whole time. You started sending it. Tomorrow we lock it in.

10 Day 10

CLOSE

Phase: CLOSE. Today's action: Lock in your keystone habit, then point your steps toward the Sodium Trap in your Blueprint.

You did it. Ten days ago stillness was the loudest trigger for you, and you walked straight at it, literally. You named it, you broke up what fed it, you added what heals it, you supported your vessels, and you watched them respond. Take a breath and let that land. Most people never get this far.

First, lock in your keystone. You added a lot in ten days, and you do not need to white-knuckle all of it forever. You need ONE non-negotiable habit from this reset that holds the gain for life. For the Stillness Trigger, that keystone is your daily movement ritual: a short movement break every 60 to 90 minutes, plus the 20-minute unhurried walk. One ritual, and it keeps the signal flowing all day and give your vessels the sustained flexibility they were missing. It costs nothing, it travels with you, and it is the whole engine of this trigger. If your body limits your walking, your keystone is the seated or chair-based version of the same thing, done just as faithfully. Pick your exact daily version today and commit to it.

Now, a word about where your steps lead next. The Stillness Trigger rarely travels alone. It has a close companion, and it is hidden sodium. Here is how they hold hands. Slow circulation and long stillness let fluid pool and linger, exactly the puffiness you have been watching in your ankles and rings. Hidden sodium pulls even more fluid into that system and makes your body hold onto it. So stillness slows the flow and sodium raises the volume, and together they push your pressure up through the same door of fluid and circulation. If you have been noticing swelling and tighter rings by evening, that is often the two of them working together.

So here is your next step. Go back to your Blood Pressure Blueprint, the guide that brought you here, and read the Sodium Trap pages next. You already know the shape now: find it, eliminate it, add the practice, add the foods, support your body, monitor, watch it heal. You learned the method here. Now carry it to the trigger that most often travels beside this one. Address them together and your numbers have far less to push against.

Do this today:

1. Choose your exact daily keystone: your movement break every 60 to 90 minutes and your 20-minute unhurried walk (or the seated, chair-based version). Commit to it as the one habit you keep no matter what.
2. Open your Blood Pressure Blueprint and turn to the Sodium Trap pages. That is your next read.
3. Keep your herbs and foods going as your steady backbone, with the movement break as the anchor everything stacks on.

Well done on this one. Keep your movement break and your daily walk going, starting today. Your vessels have found their rhythm again. Go live it.

A WORD FROM YOUR NURSE

Joel Polley, RN

I spent twenty years at the ICU and ER bedside, watching blood pressure from the crash-cart side of medicine. One of the quietest lessons I learned is that the body was never built to sit still for a living. It is built to move, often and gently, all day long. When the movement stops, the vessels stop hearing the one signal they most need, and the number climbs, even in people who are doing everything else right.

I am a registered nurse and a naturopathic practitioner, and I built this to put the why back in your hands, so a blood pressure reading stops being a verdict and starts being a conversation you understand. Everything here walks alongside your doctor, never instead of your doctor. Your data is your power. Your doctor is your ally.

And if your knees, your hips, or your balance make walking hard, hear me one more time: chair-based movement counts. The signal is what matters, not the height you rise to or the miles you cover. Send the signal, in whatever body you have today. Go live it.

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